

Henri's Meeting Macrostructure

Simple habits to operate your way into greater familiarity with the Liberating Structures repertoire

“Repetition is a form of change” - Brian Eno

Daily (5-15 mins)

Purpose: To review workflow & options, coordinate around immediate needs, and creatively adapt to changes in the operating environment

Consistent Structures:



Tasks:

1. Kanban Review or Slack Update
2. WINFY Tracking

Other Structures:



Weekly (30 - 60 mins)

Purpose: To notice important shifts in the operating environment while enhancing relational coordination across functions or business units; identify complex coordination challenges or problems that require a more focused and deliberate approach

Consistent Structures:



Tasks:

1. Kanban & Ecocycle Review
2. Populate & Coordinate Design of Monthly Working Sessions
3. WINFY Tracking

Other Structures:



Monthly (90 mins - 3 hours)

Purpose: To face down and make rapid progress on the most complex, chronic and entangled problems or challenges facing a work group

Tasks & Responsibilities:

1. Select topic/challenge/problem from Weekly backlog
2. Ensemble of at least 2 people takes responsibility for designing, inviting, and coordinating a working session
3. Progress and emergent needs get addressed at the next weekly meeting

Possible/Likely Structures:



Quarterly (3 hours - 1 day)

Purpose: To tune operational and strategic investments/arrangements towards current reality AND the needs of an emergent future

Consistent Structures:



Additional Possible/Likely Structures:



Reverse Kanban, Strategy Gameplan

Annual (1 - 3 days)

Purpose: To rigorously confront reality and notice how the organizing macrostructures are enabling or dampening more agile responses to emergent challenges.

Consistent Structures:



Additional Possible/Likely Structures:



Reverse Kanban, Strategy Gameplan

Specify Your Meeting Types Via 1-2-4-All

First by yourself, answer three questions:

1. Do you have different types of meetings?
2. What purpose does each type serve?
3. Create a chart similar to the table below

Now, move to 2-4-All

Daily	Weekly	Special Topic	Quarterly	Annual
Purpose:	Purpose:	Purpose:	Purpose:	Purpose:
<i>15 minutes</i>	<i>30-60 minutes</i>	<i>60-90 minutes</i>	<i>½-1 day</i>	<i>Multi-day</i>



What purpose
does each type
of meeting
serve?

Dig deeper into the
purpose of each meeting
type: why, why, why is it
important?

5 minutes in the
whole group

1 minute alone

1-2-4-All
Engage everyone
simultaneously in
generating
questions/ideas/sug
gestions

4 minutes in a
foursome

2 minutes in a
pair



What purpose
does each type
of meeting
serve?

Dig deeper into the
purpose of each meeting
type: why, why, why is it
important?

5 minutes in the
whole group

1-2-4-All
Engage everyone
simultaneously in
generating
questions/ideas/sug
gestions

1 minute alone

4 minutes in a
foursome

2 minutes in a
pair

Linking Purpose To Meeting Types

Meeting **Macro**structure



* *Open* means the agenda is created by participants at the beginning of the meeting

Sample Purposes & Meeting Types

Daily	Weekly	Special Topic	Monthly	Quarterly
Coordinate daily individual tasks; ask for help critical to making immediate progress.	Take on challenges lingering from <i>Daily</i> meetings: what needs attention NOW to advance work NEXT WEEK.	Address a budget or a coordination problem that is time sensitive and can't wait for <i>Monthly</i> .	Address a single challenge that requires a couple of hours of working to decide how to proceed.	Dig into strategic issues that need to be addressed vis-a-vis future options and longer-term ambitions.
<i>15 minutes</i>	<i>30-60 minutes</i>	<i>60-90 minutes</i>	<i>½-1 day</i>	<i>Multi-day</i>

Where are you starting, really?

Rate your team's Facilitation & Purposefulness (nirvana=10)

Level	Facilitation (Shaping Next Steps)	Purposefulness (Making Purpose Clear)
5	Participants share responsibility for matching microstructures to the challenges at hand	Arising out of the group interaction, purpose is renewed and evolves over time
4	Distributed peer-to-peer, individuals seek input rather than permission	Purpose drives mutually shaped action distributed among team members and roles
3	For meetings and teamwork, everyone generates purpose together	Each person understands how their role and authority serves the purpose
2	Facilitator defers to leader, drives buy-in to manage conflict	Organizational purpose clear; fuzzy roles, authority, & team purpose
1	"Going through the motions" inclusiveness	Purpose assumed but not explicit
0	No facilitator or interaction method specified	Accountability without authority or clear purpose

Worthy Purposes for a Meeting

Yes, Yes, Yes

1. Making sense of a shared challenge or crisis from multiple points of view
2. Shaping choices together about how to move forward on a complex challenge
3. Getting help and advice from peers (e.g., to make decisions, take actions, formulate goals, or make investments)

No, No, No

~~Updating progress~~ *re: work that does not require coordination or interdependent action*

~~Presenting information~~ *that could be shared in advance (often PPT)*

~~Getting buy-in~~ *on a decision made in advance*

Done

Doing Now

This Week

This Month

This Quarter

This Year

